

Staffers rebel at Heritage think tank

Foundation president's defense of Carlson leads to rebukes, resignations

BY ISAAC ARNSDORF AND JACOB BOGAGE

The Heritage Foundation is erupting in open revolt against its president, Kevin Roberts, as the right-wing think tank struggles to deal with internal and external anger over his defense of former Fox News host Tucker Carlson.

The furor began after Carlson invited Nick Fuentes, a white nationalist who routinely espouses antisemitic views, onto his popular podcast. Roberts then posted a video that castigated a "venomous coalition" and "the globalist class" for attacking Carlson, whom Roberts called "a close friend of the Heritage Foundation." Numerous Heritage staffers and conservative figures said the comments played on antisemitic tropes.

A staff meeting Wednesday — Roberts's latest attempt to quell a week of resignations and condemnations over his defense of Carlson — was marked with calls for him to resign and squabbles over whether Christian employees would be forced to participate in Jewish rituals.

At least five members of Heritage's antisemitism task force have now resigned in protest, and distinguished fellow Chris DeMuth left the organization. On

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JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

Then-House Speaker Nancy Pelosi (D-California) holds the gavel after adjourning the 117th Congress on Jan. 3, 2023, at the U.S. Capitol.

Pelosi announces her retirement from Congress

BY PAUL KANE

Rep. Nancy Pelosi (D-California) announced Thursday that she will not run for reelection next year, ending a nearly four-decade congressional career that saw her become the first female speaker of the House and wield more power on Capitol Hill than almost any man has before or — so far — after her.

"I will not be seeking reelection to Congress. With a grateful heart, I look forward to my final year of service as your representative,"

Former speaker to wrap up a nearly four-decade career without parallel

Pelosi, 85, said in a video released to her constituents in San Francisco that featured highlights of her career.

The Democrat announced her decision following the success of a redistricting ballot initiative launched by California Demo-

crats. On Tuesday, voters gave the state license to redraw California's 52 House districts in Democrats' favor. Pelosi supported the effort, and its victory caps her quarter-century effort to make California the bedrock of Democratic politics on Capitol Hill.

The first speaker to serve multiple terms since the 1950s, Pelosi was known for bending the chamber to her will through brute strength and keeping her often narrow majority in line through a combination of persuasion and fear of punishment. Her legacy

will include the passage of sweeping laws like the 2010 Affordable Care Act and the 2022 Inflation Reduction Act, which was intended to battle climate change, an issue she often called her landmark agenda item.

Pelosi, who grew up the youngest of seven children in a family led by Baltimore Mayor Thomas D'Alesandro, relocated to San Francisco after marrying Paul Pelosi, an investor whom she met during her college years in Washington.

SEE PELOSI ON A9

As U.S. cuts back, China lures scientists

Funding, immigration challenges here help Beijing attract top talent

BY KATRINA NORTHROP AND RUDY LU

SHENZHEN, CHINA — When Stephen Ferguson, a 35-year-old New Yorker, walked into a conference room here in June, he was shocked to find 50 people from China's top scientific institution eager to hear about his experience working in this southern Chinese city.

Ferguson was recruited in 2023 as a biology researcher — despite having only been to China once before — and the delegation from the prestigious Chinese Academy of Sciences wondered what could be done to make the research environment first-rate.

The fact they wanted to hear from "some random guy from the U.S." symbolized something much larger to him: "I feel like I'm in an environment where science is really being promoted — it's growing, and they're attracting a lot of talent," he said. "They are making it easy to say yes."

Ferguson is far from the only American scientist saying yes.

Over the past decade, there has been a rush of scholars — many

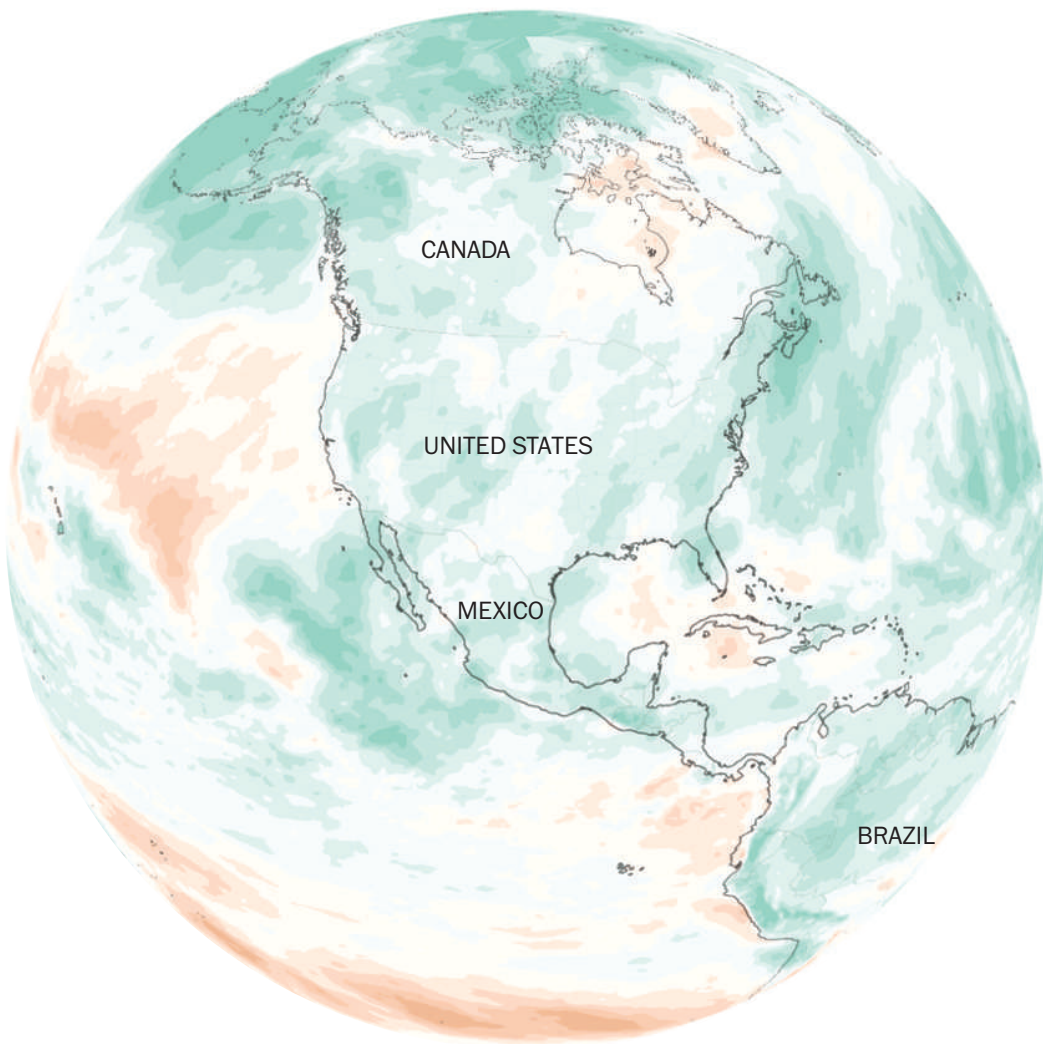
SEE CHINA ON A14

DEADLY RIVERS IN THE SKY

A Post investigation shows how hotter weather, waterlogged air fuel increasingly dangerous storms

Change in annual peak vapor transport

2009-2024 vs. 1992-2008



Source: A Washington Post analysis based on ECMWF-ERA5 atmospheric reanalysis

THE WASHINGTON POST

This article is by Ben Noll, Sarah Kaplan, Niko Kommenda, Kevin Crowe and John Muyskens

There are invisible rivers streaming across the sky — massive plumes of moisture borne over the oceans and wafted across the continents.

When this moisture is released back down to Earth, it can result in a drizzle or a deluge.

In 2024, unprecedented levels of moisture drove many of the year's worst downpours — from Hurricane Helene to a super typhoon in Southeast Asia and the devastating floods that took Valencia, Spain, by surprise.

A new Washington Post investigation reveals where climate change has supercharged the movement of moisture through the skies.

The Post's analysis, based on state-of-the-art weather data and computer models of the climate system, reveals how rising global temperatures have made the atmosphere more waterlogged — providing fuel for wetter and more dangerous storms. In the past 85 years, The Post found, the amount of water vapor moving through Earth's atmosphere has increased 12 percent. That increase is equivalent to 35 Mississippi Rivers flowing through the air every second.

But this moisture is not distributed equally around the planet. Nor are its effects evenly felt.

SEE STORMS ON A10

Trump's policy on passports can proceed

Justices revive order that requires sex designation to match birth certificate

BY JUSTIN JOUVENAL

The Supreme Court on Thursday allowed the Trump administration to end for now a policy under which people can self-identify their gender on passports, the latest in a string of decisions by the high court rolling back gay and transgender rights.

The justices' decision revives an executive order by President Donald Trump that required passports to reflect a person's sex as listed on their birth certificate. A lower court had blocked Trump's policy. The high court's order will remain in effect while the legal fight over the Trump policy plays out in the lower courts.

"Displaying passport holders' sex at birth no more offends equal protection principles than displaying their country of birth — in both cases, the Government is merely attesting to a historical fact without subjecting anyone to differential treatment," the majority wrote.

The court's unsigned order did not reveal which justices voted to allow Trump's policy to go

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IN THE NEWS

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THE REGION House Republicans say that the president of George Mason University broke the law and lied to Congress over a DEI inquiry. B13

WEEKEND Feast on Indian street food, "Swediopian" and Korean fine dining in the evolving NoMa.

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